

1. Research on Newsletter Analytics

Understanding how our internal newsletters perform is vital for optimizing their impact. Key metrics to consider include:

1. **Open Rate:** The percentage of recipients who open the newsletter.
2. **Click-Through Rate (CTR):** The percentage of recipients who click on a link within the newsletter.
3. **Engagement Rate:** A broader metric often combining opens, clicks, and time spent viewing.
4. **Frequency:** How many newsletters were sent out per team over a seventeen month period.
5. **Average Open Rate:** The average open rate of each team.
6. **Unique Opens:** Amount of individual people who opened the newsletter.
7. **Total Opens:** Total number of times the newsletter was opened.

Metrics Analysis

Three main patterns can be inferred from the general analytics:

1. Lower frequency correlates with higher engagement and open rates, with Education being an outlier. Global Communications sends the most newsletters (4.53), but does not lead in Open-Rate (71.46%), Engagement Rate (62.54%), and Click-Through Rate, which is the lowest for all teams (0.5). On the other hand, [REDACTED] has the highest Open Rate and Click-Through Rate despite its send frequency of 0.35, suggesting quality, content, and targeting are more effective than volume of newsletters. On the overall spectrum, most teams that have a lower Frequency, have a relatively high engagement and open rate [REDACTED], with a few outliers.
2. High engagement doesn't necessarily correlate with a high open rate or high click-through rate. [REDACTED] has the highest engagement rate of (73.69%), but a lower click-through rate of 4.5, meaning engagement might be happening inside of the newsletter versus through link clicks. While also having the highest engagement rate, [REDACTED] has a low open rate (64%) as well, meaning that those who do open the newsletter find themselves engaging more with the content versus other team newsletters, but the newsletters themselves are not grabbing the attention for everyone to open them and read the content. For future research, if we could look into [REDACTED] content to see what they have that is engaging employees, while looking at what [REDACTED] does to keep their

highest open rates, we could combine the two and come up with an effective strategy.

3. Timing does not seem to affect open rate fluctuations, but only the team differences, as there is not a consistent pattern that can be found. As shown through the Open Rate Outliers/Monthly Trends graph, there is no consistent pattern between all of the teams over the seventeen month basis, so it can be inferred that the months do not outright affect the newsletter open rate trends as a whole but rather by individual teams.

- **Additional Notes:**

- Frequency and Click-Through Rate have the most extreme spreads and skewness (due to single-team outliers).
- Open Rate is relatively tight, with one high outlier (Ireland Site).
- Team differences contribute more to the spread than time differences.
- Engagement Rate has a large spread but is more evenly distributed than CTR.
- Outliers (Global Communications for frequency, Ireland Site for open/CTR) heavily influence the perception of performance.

Heatmap:

- **Frequency (# of newsletters sent out between March 2024 and July 2025):** [REDACTED] has the highest frequency of newsletters sent out.
- **Average Open Rate:** [REDACTED] has the highest average open rate, indicating their newsletters are more frequently opened.
- **Average Engagement Rate:** [REDACTED] has the highest average engagement rate, suggesting that their newsletters are highly engaging.
- **Average Click-Through Rate:** [REDACTED] also has the highest average click-through rate, implying that their newsletters are very effective in driving user interaction.

'Average Open Rate Over Time by Newsletter Category' Graph:

- Shows the average open rate for each newsletter category over time, allowing for a visual comparison of their performance and the identification of any outliers or trends.
- **Overall Trend:**
 - The open rates for most newsletter categories generally fluctuate between 60% and 90%.
 - Categories like [REDACTED] and [REDACTED] consistently maintain high open rates, consistently above or near 80%.

- '[REDACTED]' generally has lower open rates compared to other categories, most of the time staying below 70%.
- **Outlier Categories:**
 - '[REDACTED]' shows a significant dip in open rate in June 2025, dropping to approximately 57.25%, which is an outlier compared to its usual performance and other categories.
 - Conversely, '[REDACTED]' also exhibits a peak in October 2024 with an open rate of 98%, indicating a period of exceptionally high engagement.
 - '[REDACTED]' in total has the most fluctuations in Open Rates.
- **Monthly Trends:**
 - **High Months:** October 2024 and November 2024 appear to be strong months for several categories, with '[REDACTED] Monthly Newsletter' reaching its highest point in October 2024.
 - **Low Months:** June 2025 stands out as a month with a notable dip in open rates for the '[REDACTED] Monthly Newsletter' category. Other categories generally maintain their typical range, suggesting that the dip in June 2025 is specific to that category rather than a widespread trend.
- **Summary:** While overall open rates are generally healthy, there are specific newsletter categories that either significantly outperform or underperform, and certain months may see higher or lower engagement depending on the content and audience of the newsletters.

'Average Open Rate Over Time' Graph:

- **Overall Trend:** Displays a general, fluctuating increase between March 2024 and July 2025, with a noticeable decline in Open Rates between December 2024 and February 2025. It could be inferred that this is due to the holiday season.

'Average Open Rate % by Team Name' Graph:

- **Overall Trend:** The '[REDACTED]' has the highest Open Rate of 86%, with Engineering having the lowest Open Rate percent of 64%. Across the board, most teams seem to be in the 70-75% range.

'Average Click-Through Rate Over Time' Graph:

- **Overall Trend:** The average click-through rate over time remains at a near-consistent rate between 6-7% with outliers in July and December 2024, with July peaking around 14% and December around 12%.

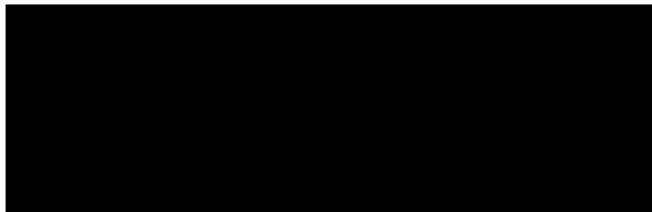
'Monthly Trends of Newsletter Performance Metrics' Chart:

- Illustrates the fluctuations in average open rate, click-through rate, and engagement rate over time.
- **Overall Trend:**
 - **Open Rate:** The average open rate shows some variability but generally remains strong, with peaks and dips throughout the months. There isn't a clear consistent upward or downward trend across the entire period, suggesting that open rates are influenced by various factors that change month-to-month.
 - **Click-Through Rate:** The average click-through rate appears to be the most volatile metric, with significant fluctuations. This could be due to specific campaigns or content types in certain months that drove higher clicks, or a lower overall base rate making individual spikes more pronounced.
 - **Engagement Rate:** The average engagement rate generally mirrors the trends in open rate, as it is directly tied to total opens. It also shows some month-to-month variability, indicating that the effectiveness of content in driving deeper engagement varies.

'Top 5 Categories' Graphs:

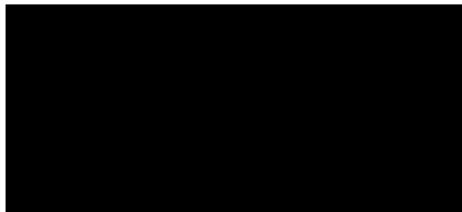
- **Average Click-Through Rate:**

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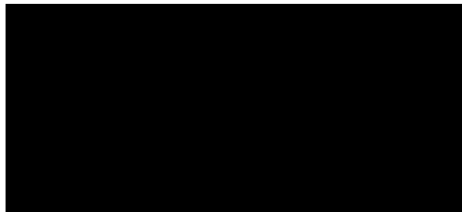
- **Average Engagement Rate**

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- **Average Open Rate**

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- **Average Time on Intranet Hub per Year**

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Types of newsletters being sent out:

1. Release Communications
2. Product/Engineering/Support Updates
3. General Company/Global Communications
4. Marketing/Demand Gen
5. Site/Location Specific Newsletters
6. Specialized/Thematic Newsletters

'Metrics by Newsletter Type' Charts:

'Average Engagement Rate by Newsletter Type':

● **Overall Trend:**

- [Redacted] have the highest average engagement rate at approximately 68.13%.
- [Redacted] follow with an average engagement rate of about 64.42%.
- [Redacted] have an average engagement rate of approximately 62.71%.
- [Redacted] show an average engagement rate of around 59.49%.
- [Redacted] have an average engagement rate of about 56.33%.
- [Redacted] newsletters have the lowest average engagement rate at approximately 47.30%.

- **Summary:** [Redacted] tend to have higher engagement, while Marketing/Demand Generation newsletters show lower engagement.

'Average Open Rate by Newsletter Type':

● **Overall Trend:**

- [Redacted] have the highest average open rate at approximately 84.33%.
- [Redacted] newsletters follow with an average open rate of about 83.08%.

- [REDACTED] have an average open rate of approximately 79.25%.
- [REDACTED] newsletters show an average open rate of around 75.61%.
- [REDACTED] have an average open rate of about 70.55%.
- [REDACTED] newsletters have the lowest average open rate at approximately 60.94%.
- **Summary:** [REDACTED]
Generation newsletters tend to have higher open rates, while Product/Engineering/Support Updates newsletters show lower open rates.

'Recurring Newsletters' Chart:

- **Overview of Labels:**
 - [REDACTED] This series includes newsletters like "June 2025_Global Employee Newsletter" and "July [REDACTED] Newsletter," indicating a recurring global employee communication.
 - [REDACTED] This series refers to "[REDACTED]ation" newsletters, such as [REDACTED] Release Communication" and [REDACTED] Release Communication," which are sent out regularly for business application releases.
 - [REDACTED] This series includes [REDACTED] Release Communication" newsletters, sent out on multiple dates.
 - **Company Weekly Press, Blog, Events:** This is a consistent weekly series, with variations in the date included in the name, such as "Company Weekly Press, Blog, Events Highlights - November 12, 2024" and "Company Weekly Press, Blog, Events Highlights - May 12, 2025".
 - [REDACTED] This series, exemplified by "March 2024 Community & Knowledge Newsletter" and "April 2024 Community & Knowledge Newsletter," is a recurring communication for community and knowledge updates.
 - [REDACTED] This series, including [REDACTED] Marketing Newsletter: April 2025" and [REDACTED] Newsletter: May 2025," indicates a recurring marketing communication.
 - [REDACTED] This series includes [REDACTED] and "Q4 Development Download," suggesting a quarterly recurring update.
 - [REDACTED] This series represents recurring newsletters from the [REDACTED] with examples like [REDACTED] and [REDACTED]

- [REDACTED] - 14 January 2025".
- [REDACTED]: This series, such as [REDACTED] - July 2024" and [REDACTED] - September 2024," indicates a quarterly recurring IT update.
- [REDACTED] This series, including [REDACTED] Newsletter - June 2024" and [REDACTED] Newsletter - September 2024," suggests a quarterly recurring newsletter specific to the Ireland site.
- [REDACTED] This series includes [REDACTED] and [REDACTED] December 2024," indicating a recurring partner marketing communication.
- [REDACTED] This series includes [REDACTED] Internal Newsletter March 25" and [REDACTED] Internal Newsletter July 25," indicating a recurring internal partner marketing communication.

These newsletters were identified by standardizing their names to remove dates, fiscal years, and other specific identifiers, and then checking if the standardized names appeared with multiple unique send dates. This method helps to group different instances of the same recurring newsletter series.

'Average Open Rate for Recurring Newsletter Series'

- [REDACTED] has the highest average open rate at approximately 83.6%.
- [REDACTED] follows with an average open rate of about 79.4%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of approximately 78.5%.
- [REDACTED] shows an average open rate of around 78.83%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of about 76.0%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of approximately 71.33%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of about 70.68%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of approximately 68.33%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of about 68.2%.
- [REDACTED] has an average open rate of approximately 60.94%.
- [REDACTED] has the lowest average open rate at approximately 52.5%.

2. Newsletter Strategy

1. **Content Pillars:** Define the Company's themes or categories of content to ensure consistency and relevance ([REDACTED] project updates, and HR announcements).

2. **Cadence:** Continue a consistent publishing schedule (e.g., weekly, bi-weekly, monthly) to manage expectations on a team-by-team basis. For example, Global Communications currently does a weekly newsletter. Staying consistent with the publishing schedule allows the audience to stay engaged and form an expectation.
3. **Target Audience Segmentation:** Segment internal teams to deliver more personalized and relevant content. Remove content that is irrelevant to each team.
4. **Calls to Action (CTAs):** Define what actions you want recipients to take after reading to boost engagement rates across teams (e.g., read a full article, attend an event, provide feedback). For example, attach a feedback link after an EVOLVE event with an incentive such as a raffle.
5. **Feedback Mechanisms:** Incorporate ways for employees to provide feedback on the newsletter content and format to increase engagement (e.g., polls, surveys, quizzes; act on results and close the loop).

Best Practices

- **Sending newsletters earlier in the day (Company already does this).**
 - [21.5% of all emails](#) are opened in the first hour of someone's day.
 - Highest newsletter open rates are around [6 AM and 5 PM](#).
- **To keep people engaged, make newsletters "skimmable."**
 - People only spend [40 seconds reading newsletters](#) and if it takes longer, they'll stop reading, so keep under 40 seconds.
 - The average person [receives over 100 emails a day](#)– not including spam.
 - [80-85% of people use their phones to access emails](#).
- **Next Steps: Consider ways beyond email to communicate.**
 - According to a 2020 survey, [Gen Z could free the world from email](#). People over 30 used email as their primary internal communication tool, while people under 30 used Google Docs most, then Zoom and iMessage.
 - [66% of consumers](#) reported short-form videos as the most engaging type of social media content in 2022 - Company should look into incorporating short-length multimedia content such as videos or gifs.

3. Potential Partners for New Newsletter Plugin

To further enhance the functionality and integration of our internal newsletter, exploring a new plugin is recommended. Criteria for potential partners includes:

- **Most Ideal:**

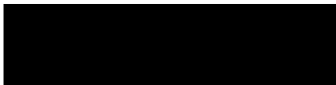
- Seamless integration with existing internal platforms such as Workday and [REDACTED]
- Advanced, descriptive analytics and reporting dashboards.
- Interactive elements (polls, surveys, quizzes) to incorporate multimedia content and to boost engagement rate.
- Personalization capabilities based on user roles or preferences.
- Improved design customization options to optimize Company's personal branding.
- More effective targeting methods to enhance engagement.
- Streamlined approval processes to regulate newsletter publishing access.
- Improved engagement metrics.
- **Ideal but not Necessary:**
 - Simplified and visually pleasing content creation
 - AI Integration/ Digital AI assistant
 - Automatic translation feature for global newsletters

Additional Notes: Research will focus on partners specializing in internal communications software or enterprise-level email solutions. Specific partners to investigate include those with a strong track record of successful integrations and robust API support.

List of Potential Partners:



[Refer to for potential partner notes.](#)



Highly rated on Gartner Peer Insights [REDACTED] and included in Forrester and G2 reviews for its strength in employee communication features such as calendaring, segmentation, newsletters, and analytics reviews.

Integration	Pricing	Services
Integration with Intranet: Standalone platform, but does integrate with future Intranet. [REDACTED] and integrate information [REDACTED]	Staffbase Email Business: \$35,500 • Drag and drop email designer • Template & file management • Targeting & personalization • In-depth analytics	Admin Licenses: Unlimited

Implementation timeline (TBD):	• <i>Smart campaigns</i> • <i>Smart Impact</i> • <i>Analytics API</i>	Customization/Branding: Create folders to organize newsletter groups/teams. Certain teams can be limited on what they send. Company personalization is efficient, visually pleasing, and easy to do. Easily add multimedia content like videos, surveys, etc. to boost engagement rates. Block out specific content pieces that are not relevant to their team/title/location if newsletter is sent out to multiple teams at once.
Key Contacts [REDACTED]	Core Launch Business & Enterprise [REDACTED] Core Support [REDACTED]	Analytics: Relatively good analytics with click-through rates, open rate, and total activity. Click map with percentage of people who clicked each item.
File Size: All parts of the newsletter should be visible regardless of file size. With Gmail, there is a Maximum file size of 102 KB. For images and attachments, these are the size limitations: • Videos: up to 4 GB • Images: up to 25 MB • Attachments: up to 2 GB	Estimated Year 1 Total: Business: \$ [REDACTED] Enterprise: [REDACTED]	Approval Process: Can lock down access to modify the templates; Calendar for blocking out certain times/dates for newsletter send outs.
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	AI assisted content: Translate using AI/Microsoft Translate for global newsletters. Companion editor, companion search, Microsoft 365 copilot agent.

[REDACTED]

A purpose-built internal comms suite, cited in Gartner's Market Guide for Employee Communications Applications. It delivers multi-channel personalization, segmented targeting, deep analytics, and enterprise-grade AI features to assist communicators in scaling and optimizing employee messaging.

Integration	Pricing	Services
Integration with Intranet: Integration using employee data and email addresses via API or an SF2P Flat File with HRIS system of choice; integrate with everything	[REDACTED]	Admin Licenses: 5, but can add [REDACTED]
Implementation timeline: [REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	Customization/Branding: Can create as many templates as needed. Can block out specific content pieces that are not relevant to their team/title/location if newsletter is sent out to multiple

		teams at once. Allows multimedia content but video will not play within gmail itself.
Key Contacts: [REDACTED] ([REDACTED]) – Senior Account Executive	<i>Estimated Year Base 1 Total:</i> [REDACTED]	Analytics: Very thorough analytics with roles determining visible data. Can see specific people who have not read email.
File Size: All parts of the newsletter will be visible regardless of file size.		Approval Process: Multiple different templates, but can lock down access to modify the templates; can approve comments, likes, etc.
[REDACTED]		AI assisted content: Translate using AI for global newsletters in 42 different languages

Ideal Potential Partner Recommendation

Staffbase

Although both Staffbase and Poppulo have a lot of similarities, Staffbase would be my ideal partner recommendation due to several reasons:

1. **Price:** Although Poppulo's base pricing point is much closer to our budget, when factoring in the fifteen other admin licenses that might need access, the total is over \$60k, about \$19k higher than Staffbase. Staffbase has unlimited licenses with a base rate of \$41k, which also guarantees flexibility.
2. **Customization/Branding:** Staffbase's customization is easy, effective, with no limit on created templates. The presentation is efficient, and much more visually pleasing compared to Poppulo. Multimedia content is able to be placed within the newsletter with no issues, and can play video within the newsletter itself.
3. **AI Assisted Content Creation:** Staffbase utilizes AI as a companion editor, companion search, and a Microsoft 365 copilot agent to create and assist with content. Prompts can easily be generated with advanced AI technology. Poppulo does not have this feature.
4. **Integration Capabilities:** Although Staffbase is standalone with current Intranet, it does integrate with future partners. Even if it doesn't integrate with Okta, it has an SSO and integration with Confluence and Google.

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